

Lead Qualification Standard

One shared definition for every bucket, so any rep grading the same lead lands in the same place.

Principle: Buckets rest on observable, verifiable signals — a confirmed budget, a dated lease expiry, an LOI on the table — not on how interested a lead *feels*.

Step 1 — Record the qualifying signals

No lead is bucketed until these five fields are attempted.

1. Requirement	Use type, size (SF), location/submarket, specs. Defined or exploratory?
2. Timeline	Move-in date, lease expiry, or deal deadline. The single most important CRE signal.
3. Budget / Financing	Tenant: budget range confirmed. Buyer/investor: capital, pre-approval, or proof of funds.
4. Authority	Decision-maker, influencer, or unknown? Is there a committee or board?
5. Engagement stage	Furthest action reached: inquiry → meeting → tour → proposal/term sheet → LOI.

Step 2 — Assign the bucket

Bucket	What it means	Qualifies only if it meets ALL of
HOT	<i>A real deal, with the right person, moving now.</i>	— Defined requirement (use, size, location, specs) — Decision-maker engaged and responsive — Budget / financing confirmed — Timeline to decision or move within ~90 days — Active deal action: tour done, proposal/term sheet exchanged, or LOI in play
WARM	<i>A genuine opportunity that needs working, not closing.</i>	— Defined requirement — Identified, responsive decision-maker — At least one meeting or tour held — Falls short of HOT on exactly one axis — usually timeline (~3–12 months) or budget (indicated, not yet proofed) — No LOI yet
COLD	<i>A possible need, but too little is known to forecast it.</i>	— Requirement vague or exploratory — Timeline undefined or beyond 12 months — Budget unknown — Inquiry-only or low responsiveness; no meeting held
NURTURE / FUTURE	<i>A qualified need with a dated but distant trigger — inactive by design, not neglect.</i>	— Lead is real and reasonably qualified — Trigger event is known and dated but distant (e.g., lease expires in 18 months) — No current activity is expected yet — Kept separate from COLD so high-value future

Bucket	What it means	Qualifies only if it meets ALL of
		deals aren't written off
LOST	<i>Was a viable, qualified deal that did not convert. Requires a reason code.</i>	– Reached real qualification but did not close – Signed/leased/bought elsewhere, requirement cancelled or shelved, or went dark after active engagement – MUST carry a reason code: competitor, price, timing, no-decision, unresponsive, etc.
DISQUALIFIED	<i>Never a fit — was never winnable. Kept out of LOST to protect win-rate data.</i>	– No budget, no authority, or no real need – Outside service area or asset class, or bad-faith inquiry – Requires a reason code from the disqualification list

The rules that keep it consistent across reps

1. **Gating tie-breaker.** A lead gets the highest tier for which it meets EVERY must-have. Miss one HOT criterion and it is WARM — never “HOT-ish.” This stops pipeline inflation.
2. **Mandatory re-grading.** Re-evaluate on a cadence: HOT every 7 days, WARM every 30. A HOT lead that goes silent past the threshold automatically drops a tier.
3. **Axis priority.** Timeline sets the tier; missing budget or authority is an automatic disqualifier from HOT. Apply this order identically when reps disagree.
4. **One reason code.** Every LOST and DISQUALIFIED lead carries one coded reason from a fixed list — not free text. This turns closed leads into pipeline intelligence.
5. **Calibration test.** Hand the same 10 anonymized leads to 3 reps. If they don't agree on at least 8, the criteria are still too subjective — tighten them.

Note: Default thresholds (90-day HOT window, re-grade cadences) suit office/tenant leasing. Investment sales and large industrial acquisitions run on longer clocks — calibrate the timelines to your segment.